



Owning the cage: Afshan Fathima says she knew she was meant to be a fighter when she stepped into the fighting cage for her first sparring session. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

says she finally got the chance to pursue her passion.

"I always wanted to do some sort of fitness activity. So, in my third year of college, I joined a crossfit gym. The gym where I trained also had a sign for mixed martial arts classes, but they didn't have any instructors. That was the first time I had heard about mixed martial arts.

Although they didn't have classes at the gym. I did a Google search and found out about Combat Kinetics Chennai and coach Ajit Sigamani," she says.

At that time, Afshan says she told her parents she was just staying back to play basketball in her college since she knew the alternative would be something